

Topic: Life in Makkah

Pledges of Aqabah (Spread of Islam in Yathrib)

Q (a) Give an account of the events surrounding the Pledges of 'Aqaba and the main details in them. [10]

Structure of Answer		
Para 1 (Starter & 1 st Conversion)	Para 2 (1 st Pledge of Aqabah)	Para 3 (2 nd Pledge of Aqabah)
- A brief starter mentioning deaths of Abu Talib and Khadija and incident of Ta'if and that Prophet (PBUH) was disturbed. - Ayas bin Muaz (RA). - The conversion of 6 pilgrims of Khazraj tribe and their promise to spread Islam in Makkah. (11th YOP/620 AD)	1st Pledge of Aqabah (12th YOP/621 AD). - Participants. - Content. - Preachers.	2nd Pledge of Aqabah (13th YOP/622 AD). - Participants. 12 In charges. - Their invitation to Prophet (PBUH). - Permission of migration.

Answer

- ☐ Prophet's (PBUH) depression over the death of Abu Talib and Khadijah.
- ☐ Unsuccessful attempt to preach at Ta'if.
- ☐ Decline in conversion rate in Makkah.
- ☐ Arrogance of Quraysh.
- ☐ In 11th year of Prophethood some pilgrims from Khazraj tribe of Yathrib visited Makkah. Prophet (PBUH) as per his habit visited them and presented Islam. Upon realizing the truthfulness of Islam, they embraced it. There were 6 people:

1) As'ad bin Zaraarah (RA)	2) Auf bin Harith (RA)	3) Rafay bin Malik (RA)
4) Qatbah bin Amir (RA)	5) Uqbah bin Amir (RA)	6) Jabir bin Abdullah (RA)

 These people worked really hard and preached Prophet's (PBUH) message with full dedication. And this was their sheer hard work and dedication that resulted in Pledges of Aqabah.
- ☐ In 12th year of Prophethood / 621 AD 12 Madinians approached Prophet (PBUH) a place called 'Aqabah' near Mina.
- ☐ 5 of them were same as previous year, Jabir bin Abdullah couldn't come. others were:

1) Muaz bin Harith (RA)	2) Zakwaan bin Ab Qais (RA)	3) Ubaadah bin Samit (RA)
Yazeed bin Salabah (RA)	5) Abbas bin Ubadah (RA)	6) Malik bin Tahaan (RA)
7) Uwaim bin Saaedah (RA)		
- ☐ This Pledge is called 1st Pledge of Aqabah. The basic content of this pledge was about worshipping one God, not stealing, not committing adultery, not killing their children, not slandering or disobeying the Prophet.
- ☐ Prophet (PBUH) sent **Abdullah bin Umm-e-Maktoom** (RA) and **Mus'ab bin Umair** (RA) with these people to teach and spread Islam. They stayed at **As'ad bin Zararah's** home. Because of their efforts, notables of tribe Aus Usaid bin Hudhair and Saad bin Muaz also embraced Islam.
- ☐ In 13th year of Prophethood / 622 AD approx. 75 Madinians led by Mus'ab bin Umar (RA) came and pledged at Aqabah.
- ☐ Some Notables were:

Ubayy bin Ka'ab (RA), Ma'az bin Jabal (RA), Ubadah bin Samit (RA), Asma bint Amr (RA)



- ☐ This Pledge is called 2nd Pledge of Aqabah.
- ☐ Prophet (PBUH) said:
 - 📖 "I invite you towards Allah and Islam"
 - Then He recited some verses of Holy Quran.
- ☐ The basic content of this pledge was about to listen to and obey the Prophet, to spend in plenty as well as scarcity, to enjoin good and forbid evil, fear no one but Allah and defend the Prophet if he needs it.
- ☐ Saad bin Zararah (RA) asked Ansar:
 - 📖 "Do you know that you're giving pledge about? It is a war against Arab and Non-Arabs, Humans and Jinns.
 - Ansaar replied:
 - 📖 "Yes! We are giving pledge about this"
- ☐ Prophet (PBUH) appointed 12 in charges among them who were responsible for spreading Islam among their tribes and in Madinah generally. Gabriel would point out towards people and Prophet (PBUH) would designate in charges.
 - 1) As'ad bin Zararah. 2) Abdullah bin Rawaha. 3) Saad bin Rabee. 4) Rafay bin Malik.
 - 5) Abdullah bin Amr. 6) Baraa bin Ma'roor. 7) Saad bin Ubaadah. 8) Munzir bin Amr.
 - 9) Ubaadah bin Samit. 10) Usaid bin Huzair. 11) Saad bin Khasmah. 12) Rafa'ah bin Abdul Munzir.
- ☐ These in charges along with other Muslims worked really hard and almost converted major population of Madinah to Islam. When they set up a strong foundation, they invited Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) to Madinah.
- ☐ Prophet (PBUH) allowed companions to migrate after Allah's permission. He migrated few days later along with Abu Bakr (RA).

Q (b) How were these pledges important for the future community of Muslims? [4]

Answer

- ☐ Pledges provided Muslim community a chance to live in peace and preach Islam with full throttle.
- ☐ Muslims spent 13 horrible years in Makkah facing Quraysh persecution and torture. Finally, migration gave them chance to get rid of Quraysh's inhuman behavior.
- ☐ Teachings in pledges provided basics of Islam that will always be relevant and effective for Muslims till the day of judgement. For instance, the idea of not killing children, worshiping one God, love of Prophet (PBUH) etc.

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